

Spanish A1 — Week 6 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner Spanish | Week 6

Theme: Food, Preferences, and Restaurants

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 6 has two goals. First: you will learn one of the most unusual structures in Spanish — *gustar* — which lets you express what you like. Second: you will get enough restaurant vocabulary and phrases to order a full meal in Spanish.

The *gustar* structure surprises almost every English speaker. But once it clicks, it opens up a whole family of useful Spanish verbs (*encantar*, *doler*, *interesar*, *molestar*) that all work the same way.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 6

By the end of Session 12, you should be able to:

Talking about preferences:

Me encanta la comida española. Me gusta mucho la tortilla española. Me gustan también los tacos, pero no me gustan los mariscos. ¿A ti te gusta la paella?

Ordering at a restaurant:

Buenas tardes. ¿Tienen mesa para dos? ... Quisiera ver la carta, por favor. ... Para mí, de primero la ensalada, y de segundo el pollo asado. ¿Qué recomienda de postre? ... La cuenta, por favor.

And answer spontaneously:

- ¿Qué te gusta comer? — Me gusta mucho la pasta. Me encantan los postres.*
- ¿Qué van a tomar? — Para mí, quisiera una tortilla y una agua sin gas.*

Gustar — The Essential Structure

Gustar works backwards from English. In English, you are the subject: "I like coffee." In Spanish, the coffee is the subject: "*Me gusta el café*" — literally, "Coffee pleases me."

The two rules:

- The verb (*gusta* / *gustan*) must agree with the thing you like — not with you.
- The indirect object pronoun (*me*, *te*, *le*, *nos*, *os*, *les*) tells us who is pleased.

If you like...	Use	Example
A singular noun or an infinitive	gusta	<i>Me gusta el café. Me gusta cocinar.</i>
A plural noun	gustan	<i>Me gustan los tacos.</i>

Who likes	Pronoun
I	me

you (informal)	te
he / she / you (formal)	le
we	nos
you all (Spain)	os
they / you all (formal/LA)	les

The most common mistake: *Yo gusto el café* — incorrect. The verb never agrees with you; it agrees with the food. Always: *Me gusta el café*.

Encantar — Same Structure, Stronger Feeling

Encantar means "to love" (for things) and works exactly like *gustar*:

- *Me encanta el chocolate.* — I love chocolate.
- *Me encantan los postres.* — I love desserts.
- *¿Te encanta cocinar?* — Do you love cooking?

Querer — For Ordering

Querer (to want) is one of the most useful verbs in a restaurant. It has a stem change: the e in the stem becomes *ie* in most forms.

Subject	Querer
yo	quiero
tú	quieres
él / ella / usted	quiere
nosotros/as	queremos
vosotros/as	queréis
ellos / ellas / ustedes	quieren

Quisiera — the polite form: "I would like." Treat it as a fixed phrase for now. It is slightly softer than *quiero* and always appropriate in a restaurant.

- *Quisiera una mesa para dos, por favor.*
- *Quisiera el menú del día.*

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 11 — before Session 12:

1. **Say your food preferences.** *Me gusta..., me gustan..., no me gusta..., no me gustan...* Choose 3 real preferences. Say them without notes on the third try.

2. **Write 5 *gustar* sentences.** Mix singular and plural. Include at least one negative and one with an infinitive (*me gusta cocinar*).
3. **Check your verb agreement.** Every sentence: is the verb *gusta* or *gustan*? Does it match the noun, not you?

After Session 12 — before Session 13:

1. **Write a short restaurant dialogue.** 6–8 lines — you as the customer. Use *quisiera* at least twice and end with *la cuenta, por favor*.
2. **Say it out loud.** Third try: no notes on the ordering phrases.
3. **Learn one food item from a country you're interested in.** Look it up. Be ready to tell the class one thing about it.

A Note on Mistakes This Week

The *gustar* error is universal. Every English speaker says “*Yo gusto el café*” at least once. Your instructor will correct it every time — not because it is a serious error, but because the habit of saying it correctly needs to form early. By Session 12, it should be automatic.

Gusta vs. gustan: if you are not sure, look at what comes after the verb. One thing → *gusta*. More than one thing → *gustan*. The verb agrees with the thing, not with you.

The goal this week is to get through a real restaurant interaction in Spanish. The grammar will come with practice.